via RESTful APIs, we can construct queries using these APIs in the Kibana editor and communicate with the server over HTTP.

To execute the samples in this chapter, you need a running environment with Elasticsearch and Kibana. If you haven't set up that environment yet, follow the instructions in Appendix A to download and install your software and bring up the Elasticsearch server and Kibana UI.

> **NOTE** Installing Elasticsearch and Kibana can come in multiple flavors, from downloading the binaries and uncompressing and installing them onto your local machine in a traditional way to using a package manager, Docker, or even the cloud. Choose the appropriate flavor of installation for development to get started.

Copy the full code to your Kibana editor

To make the coding exercises easy, I've created a ch02_getting_started.txt file under the kibana_scripts folder at the root of the repository. Copy the contents of this file as is to your installation of Kibana. You can work through the examples by executing the individual code snippets while alongside following along with the chapter's contents.

Finally, we zoom out and analyze the data by executing two types of aggregations: metric and bucket. With these aggregation types, we use queries to fetch metrics such as average, sum, minimum and maximum values, and so on. Once you have the applications running, let's get started with Elasticsearch.

2.1 Priming Elasticsearch with data

A search engine can't work on thin air! It needs data as its input so it can produce results as output when queried. We need to dump our data into Elasticsearch, which is the first step in priming the engine. But before we start storing data in Elasticsearch, let's get to know the sample application we work with in this chapter.

For our examples, we need a basic understanding of the problem domain and the data model. Let's assume we are building an online bookstore; obviously, we are not architecting the whole application—we are only interested in the data model part for our discussion. We go over the details of this fictitious bookstore in the next section as a prerequisite for our objective of working with Elasticsearch.

2.1.1 An online bookstore

To demonstrate Elasticsearch's features, let's use a fictional bookstore that sells technical books online. All we want to do is to create an inventory of books and write some queries to search through them.